

Charles Taragin

ECONOMIST

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CITIZENSHIP

United States

EDUCATION

Economics

PHD

University of Michigan

2007

Economics

MASTERS

University of Michigan

2004

Public Policy

MASTERS

University of Chicago

2000

Economics

BACHELORS

University of Chicago

1999

EXPERIENCE

Federal Trade Commission

ECONOMIST

Washington DC

June 2019 - present

Antitrust Division, U.S. Department of Justice

ECONOMIST

Washington DC

September 2007 - May 2019

- Work closely with attorneys to model and quantify the effect of mergers and other potentially anti-competitive behavior.
- Analyze the effects of various tariffs proposed by the Trump administration.
- Antitrust casework focuses on collusion and monopolization in financial markets, as well as merger analysis in the health insurance, advertising, airlines, and electricity industries.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of horizontal mergers. Versions of this code has been used in numerous antitrust investigations as well as in litigation.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of tariffs and quotas.
- Designed and coded web interfaces for merger and tariff simulation.
- Designed and maintained large databases (over 10 TB) for use in investigations and litigation.

PRESENTATIONS

DC IO DAY

5/2019

INTERNATIONAL INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION CONFERENCE

4/2019

FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION

6/2018, 7/2018

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITION NETWORK

2018

INTERNATIONAL INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION CONFERENCE

2018

FEDERAL COMMUNICATION COMMISSION

8/2018, 2013

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE

2012, 2017

PUBLICATIONS

1. Borzekowski, R, R Thomadsen, and C Taragin (June 2009). Competition and price discrimination in the market for mailing lists. *QME* **7**(2), 147–179.
2. Froeb, LM, V Mares, S Tschantz, and C Taragin (2018). The simple algebra of surplus in private values open auctions: A nested logit merger model. *Economics Bulletin* **38**(4), 2304–2312.
3. Froeb, LM, RW Pittman, CS Taragin, S Tschantz, and GJ Werden (Dec. 2018). Economics at the Antitrust Division: 2017–2018. *Review of Industrial Organization* **53**(4), 637–651.

WORKING PAPERS

1. Sheu, G and C Taragin (2018). "Simulating mergers in a vertical supply chain with bargaining". Submitted to RAND. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/330564874_Simulating_Mergers_in_a_Vertical_Supply_Chain_with_Bargaining.
2. Taragin, C and M Loudermilk (2018). "Assessing concentration measures as a proxy for competitive effects in horizontal mergers". https://www.researchgate.net/publication/330564982_Using_concentration_measures_for_optimal_screening_of_horizontal_mergers.
3. Loudermilk, M and C Taragin (2019). "Assessing the Efficacy of the vGUPPI as a Screening Tool for Vertical Mergers".
4. Taragin, C and M Loudermilk (2019). "Ex-Ante evaluation of merger harm using the 2nd score auction log odds ratio".

SOFTWARE

ANTITRUST: TOOLS FOR ANTITRUST PRACTITIONERS

2019

- A collection of tools for antitrust practitioners, including the ability to calibrate different consumer demand systems and simulate the effects of mergers under different competitive regimes.

TRADE: TOOLS FOR TRADE PRACTITIONERS

2018

- A collection of tools for trade practitioners, including the ability to calibrate different consumer demand systems and simulate the effects of tariffs and quotas under different competitive regimes.

SERVICE

US DOJ/KFTC KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE PROGRAM

2018

- Organized, co-authored and co-taught a 3 day training program for new economists at the Korean Free Trade Commission (KFTC). The purpose of this program was to train KFTC economists in how to analyze horizontal mergers.

ALGORITHMIC DOCUMENT REVIEW

2017

- Trained a series of machine learning classifiers to predict if a document is pertinent to an investigation. Once these models have been fully tested, they will greatly reduce the time needed to review the massive amount of documents received by the Antitrust Division.

R TRAINING

2012 - present

- Authored and co-taught a series of short courses for Economists and Research Analysts on R. Covered topics included: data analysis, plotting, regression analysis, mapping, interfacing with databases, and antitrust analysis.

AWARDS

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR POSITIVE EXTERNALITY

2019

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON ANTHEM/CIGNA LITIGATION

2017

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR EXTRAORDINARY ACHIEVEMENT

2016

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON NATIONAL CINEMEDIA/SCREENVISION LITIGATION

2015

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON AMERICAN/US AIRWAYS LITIGATION

2014

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR PUSHING FRONTIERS

2010

COMPUTER SKILLS

PROGRAMMING

- Python
- C++
- Java

STATISTICS

- R
- Stata
- SAS

DATABASE

- PostgreSQL
- PostGIS
- MySQL
- Microsoft SQL

MARKUP

- Markdown
- LaTeX